Teacher Dashboard User Manual - SlateSMS

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Introduction

Welcome to the SlateSMS Teacher Dashboard! This comprehensive platform provides teachers with all the tools needed to manage classes, track student progress, communicate with students and parents, and maintain academic records efficiently.

Key Benefits

- **Centralized Management**: All your teaching activities in one place
- **Real-time Updates**: Instant access to student submissions and attendance
- **AI-Enhanced Assessments**: Create and manage assessments with AI assistance
- **Comprehensive Analytics**: Track student performance and engagement
- **Seamless Communication**: Connect with students, parents, and staff
- **Multi-tenant Security**: Secure, school-specific data isolation

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Getting Started

Accessing the Dashboard

1. Navigate to your school's login page: `https://[region].slatesms.com/[school_code]/login`
2. Enter your credentials (email and password)
3. Select your school if you have access to multiple schools
4. You'll be automatically redirected to the Teacher Dashboard

Dashboard Layout

The Teacher Dashboard consists of:

- **Header**: School name, notifications, profile menu
- **Navigation Sidebar**: Quick access to all features
- **Main Content Area**: Feature-specific content
- **Quick Actions**: Common tasks accessible from the dashboard

First-Time Setup

1. **Complete Your Profile**

    - Navigate to Profile section
    - Upload profile picture
    - Verify contact information

    - Set notification preferences

2. **Review Your Classes**

    - Check assigned classes in the Classes section
    - Verify class schedules and room assignments
    - Review student rosters

3. **Explore Features**

    - Familiarize yourself with the navigation menu
    - Review available quick actions
    - Check your schedule and calendar

Dashboard Overview

Main Dashboard Tabs

The dashboard is organized into several tabs:

1. **Overview**: Summary statistics and quick actions
2. **Classes**: Your assigned classes and student rosters
3. **Courses**: Course details and management
4. **Assignments**: Assignment creation and management
5. **Assessments**: AI-enhanced and traditional assessments
6. **Analytics**: Performance metrics and insights

Quick Stats Cards

The dashboard displays key metrics:

- **Total Classes**: Number of classes you're teaching
- **Total Courses**: Number of courses assigned
- **Pending Grades**: Submissions awaiting grading
- **Attendance Rate**: Overall attendance percentage

Quick Actions

Access common tasks quickly:

- **Take Attendance**: Record daily attendance

- **Create Assignment**: Create new assignments
- **Grade Submissions**: Review and grade student work
- **Create Assessment**: Design new assessments
- **Student Messages**: Communicate with students
- **View Analytics**: Access performance insights

Core Features

Classes Management

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/classes`

Features

- View all assigned classes
- Access class details and student rosters
- Manage class-specific attendance
- View class schedules and room assignments
- Track class capacity and enrollment

Viewing Classes

1. Navigate to **Classes** from the sidebar
2. Browse your assigned classes
3. Click on a class to view details

Class Details Page

- **Student Roster**: Complete list of enrolled students
- **Schedule Information**: Class timing and frequency
- **Room Information**: Location and capacity
- **Attendance Records**: Historical attendance data
- **Quick Actions**: Take attendance, create assignments

Taking Class-Specific Attendance

1. Open a class from the Classes list
2. Click **"Take Attendance"** or navigate to the Attendance tab
3. Mark students as Present, Absent, or Late
4. Add notes if needed
5. Save attendance record

Managing Class Information

- View class capacity and current enrollment
- Check room assignments and schedules
- Access student contact information
- Review class-specific announcements

Courses Management

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/courses`

Features

- View all assigned courses
- Access course details and materials
- Manage course-specific assignments
- Track student enrollment
- View course schedules

Viewing Courses

1. Navigate to **Courses** from the sidebar
2. Browse your assigned courses
3. Click **"View Course Details"** to see full information

Course Details Page

- **Course Information**: Name, code, subject, semester
- **Student Enrollment**: List of enrolled students
- **Course Materials**: Uploaded resources and documents
- **Assignments**: Course-specific assignments
- **Schedule**: Class meeting times and locations

Managing Course Materials

- Upload documents, presentations, videos
- Organize materials by topic or week
- Share resources with students
- Track material access and downloads

Assignments

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/assignments`

Features

- Create and manage assignments
- Track student submissions
- Grade assignments
- Set due dates and availability windows
- Attach files and resources

Creating a New Assignment

1. Click **"New Assignment"** or navigate to `/dashboard/teacher/assignments/new`
2. Fill in assignment details:
    - **Title**: Assignment name
    - **Description**: Detailed instructions
    - **Class**: Select target class(es)
    - **Due Date**: Submission deadline
    - **Available From/Until**: Access window
    - **Max Points**: Total points possible
    - **Assignment Type**: Homework, Project, Quiz, etc.
3. Add attachments if needed
4. Choose assignment status:
    - **Draft**: Save for later editing
    - **Published**: Make available to students
5. Click **"Create Assignment"**

Managing Assignments

Viewing Assignments

- Filter by status (Draft, Published, Completed)
- Search by title or description
- Sort by due date, creation date, or status

Editing Assignments

1. Open an assignment from the list
2. Click **"Edit"**
3. Modify details as needed
4. Save changes

Viewing Submissions

1. Open an assignment
2. Navigate to **"Submissions"** tab
3. View student submissions
4. Download attachments
5. Grade submissions individually

Grading Assignments

1. Open an assignment with submissions
2. Click on a student's submission
3. Review submitted work
4. Enter grade and feedback
5. Save grade

Assignment Statuses

- **Draft**: Not visible to students
- **Published**: Available to students
- **Closed**: No longer accepting submissions
- **Graded**: All submissions graded

Assessments

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/assessments`

Features

- Create traditional assessments
- Use AI-Enhanced Assessment Generator
- Manage assessment questions
- Track student performance
- Generate assessment reports

Assessment Types

1. **Traditional Assessments**

    - Manual question creation
    - Full control over content
    - Custom question types

2. **AI-Enhanced Assessments**

    - AI-powered question generation
    - Multiple question types
    - Automatic question suggestions
    - Grade level alignment

Creating a Traditional Assessment

1. Navigate to **Assessments** → **New Assessment**
2. Fill in assessment details:
    - **Title**: Assessment name
    - **Description**: Instructions for students
    - **Class**: Select target class(es)
    - **Due Date**: Submission deadline
    - **Duration**: Time limit (optional)
    - **Max Points**: Total points
3. Add questions manually:
    - Click **"Add Question"**
    - Select question type (Multiple Choice, True/False, Short Answer, Essay)
    - Enter question text and options
    - Set point value
4. Save as Draft or Publish

Creating an AI-Enhanced Assessment

1. Navigate to **Assessments** → **AI Assessments** tab
2. Click **"Generate Questions"** or **"Create New Assessment"**
3. Fill in generation parameters:
    - **Subject**: Course subject
    - **Grade Level**: Target grade
    - **Chapter/Title**: Topic or chapter
    - **Question Type**: Select types (Multiple Choice, True/False, Short Answer, Essay)
    - **Number of Questions**: Desired quantity
    - **Additional Instructions**: Specific requirements
4. Click **"Generate Questions"**
5. Review generated questions
6. Select questions to include
7. Click **"Add Selected to Assessment"**
8. Complete assessment details and publish

Managing Assessments

Viewing Assessments

- Filter by type (All, Traditional, AI-Enhanced)
- Filter by status (Draft, Published, Completed)
- Search by title or description

Editing Assessments

1. Open an assessment
2. Click **"Edit"**
3. Modify questions or details
4. Save changes

Assigning to Classes

1. Open a published assessment
2. Click **"Assign to Class"**
3. Select target class(es)
4. Set availability dates
5. Confirm assignment

Viewing Results

1. Open an assessment
2. Navigate to **"Results"** or **"Submissions"** tab
3. View student performance
4. Export results if needed

Assessment Dashboard

- Access detailed analytics
- View performance metrics
- Track completion rates
- Analyze question difficulty

Grades Management

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/grades`

Features

- Create grade items
- Enter and manage grades
- Calculate weighted averages

- View grade distributions
- Export grade reports

Creating Grade Items

1. Navigate to **Grades**
2. Click **"Create Grade Item"**
3. Fill in details:
    - **Title**: Grade item name
    - **Category**: Assignment, Quiz, Exam, Project, etc.
    - **Class**: Select class
    - **Max Points**: Total possible points
    - **Weight**: Percentage weight (for weighted grading)
    - **Due Date**: Submission deadline
4. Save grade item

Entering Grades

1. Navigate to **Grades**
2. Select a grade item
3. View student list
4. Enter grades for each student:
    - Points earned
    - Percentage
    - Letter grade (if applicable)
5. Add comments or feedback
6. Save grades

Grade Calculations

Simple Average

- Sum of all points / Total possible points

Weighted Average

- Each category has a weight percentage
- Grades calculated based on category weights

Grade Distribution

- View histogram of grade distribution
- Identify struggling students
- Track class performance trends

Grade Reports

Individual Student Reports

1. Select a student from the grade item
2. View all grades for that student
3. Calculate overall average
4. Export report if needed

Class Reports

1. Select a class
2. View all grade items
3. See class average and distribution
4. Export class gradebook

Attendance

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/attendance`

Features

- Record daily attendance
- View attendance history
- Generate attendance reports
- Track attendance patterns
- Export attendance data

Taking Attendance

Quick Attendance (Dashboard)

1. Click **"Take Attendance"** from dashboard
2. Select class and date
3. Mark students as Present, Absent, or Late
4. Save attendance

Class-Specific Attendance

1. Navigate to **Classes** → Select a class
2. Click **"Attendance"** tab
3. Select date

4. Mark attendance for all students
5. Add notes if needed
6. Save record

Bulk Attendance

1. Navigate to **Attendance** page
2. Select class and date
3. Use quick actions:
    - **Mark All Present**
    - **Mark All Absent**
    - Then adjust individual students
4. Save attendance

Attendance Statuses

- **Present**: Student attended class
- **Absent**: Student did not attend
- **Late**: Student arrived after class started
- **Excused**: Absence with valid reason
- **Tardy**: Multiple late arrivals

Viewing Attendance Records

Daily View

- See attendance for a specific date
- View all classes for that day
- Quick access to edit records

Weekly/Monthly View

- Calendar view of attendance
- Color-coded attendance patterns
- Identify trends

Student History

- View individual student attendance
- Track attendance percentage
- Identify patterns or concerns

Attendance Reports

Generate Report

1. Navigate to **Attendance** → **Reports** tab
2. Select parameters:
    - Date range
    - Class(es)
    - Report type (Summary, Detailed, Student-specific)
3. Click **"Generate Report"**
4. Review report
5. Export as CSV or PDF

Report Types

- **Summary Report**: Overall attendance statistics
- **Detailed Report**: Day-by-day breakdown
- **Student Report**: Individual student history
- **Class Report**: Class-wide statistics

Lessons & Lesson Plans

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/lessons`

Features

- Create lesson plans
- Organize lessons by class and topic
- Track lesson completion
- Share lesson materials
- View lesson history

Creating a Lesson Plan

1. Navigate to **Lessons** → **New Lesson**
2. Fill in lesson details:
    - **Title**: Lesson name
    - **Class**: Select target class
    - **Course**: Associated course (optional)
    - **Lesson Type**: Lesson, Lecture, Presentation, etc.
    - **Grade Level**: Target grade
    - **Subject**: Subject area
    - **Duration**: Estimated time
3. Add lesson components:
    - **Objectives**: Learning goals
    - **Materials**: Required resources

    - **Activities**: Planned activities
    - **Assessment**: Evaluation methods
    - **Homework**: Follow-up assignments
4. Add standards alignment (if applicable)
5. Save as Draft or Publish

Managing Lessons

Viewing Lessons

- Filter by class, course, or type
- Search by title or topic
- Sort by date or status

Lesson Statuses

- **Draft**: Not yet delivered
- **Published**: Available to students
- **Completed**: Lesson delivered
- **Archived**: Historical lessons

Editing Lessons

1. Open a lesson from the list
2. Click **"Edit"**
3. Modify details as needed
4. Save changes

Sharing Lessons

- Share lesson plans with other teachers
- Export lesson plans
- Print lesson materials

Course Materials

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/materials`

Features

- Upload and organize course materials
- Share resources with students
- Manage document libraries

- Track material usage
- Organize by course or topic

Uploading Materials

1. Navigate to **Materials**
2. Select **Courses** or **Subjects** tab
3. Click **"Upload Material"**
4. Fill in details:
    - **Title**: Material name
    - **Description**: Brief description
    - **Type**: Document, Video, Link, etc.
    - **Course/Subject**: Associated course
    - **Class**: Target class (optional)
5. Upload file or add link
6. Set visibility (Public, Class-specific, Private)
7. Save material

Material Types

- **Documents**: PDFs, Word docs, presentations
- **Videos**: Educational videos, recordings
- **Links**: External resources
- **Images**: Diagrams, charts, photos
- **Archives**: ZIP files, resource packages

Organizing Materials

By Course

- Group materials by course
- Easy access for course-specific resources
- Share with enrolled students

By Subject

- Organize by subject area
- Cross-course resource sharing
- Subject-specific libraries

By Topic

- Tag materials with topics
- Create topic-based collections
- Easy search and discovery

Viewing Course Details

1. Navigate to **Materials** → **Courses** tab
2. Click **"View Course Details"** on a course
3. See all materials for that course
4. Access student enrollment
5. View course schedule

Communication Features

Messaging

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/messaging`

Features

- Send messages to students
- Communicate with parents
- Message other staff members
- Group messaging
- Message history and search

Starting a Conversation

1. Navigate to **Messaging**
2. Click **"New Message"** or **"Start Conversation"**
3. Select recipient type:
    - **Student**: Individual students
    - **Parent**: Student parents
    - **Staff**: Other teachers or staff
    - **Class**: All students in a class
4. Select recipient(s)
5. Compose message
6. Attach files if needed
7. Send message

Managing Conversations

Viewing Conversations

- See all active conversations
- Unread message indicators

- Search conversations
- Filter by type (Student, Parent, Staff)

Replying to Messages

1. Open a conversation
2. Type your reply
3. Attach files if needed
4. Send reply

Message Features

- **Read Receipts**: Know when messages are read
- **File Attachments**: Share documents and media
- **Message Search**: Find past messages
- **Archive**: Organize old conversations

Group Messaging

Class Announcements

- Send messages to entire class
- Useful for announcements and reminders
- All students receive the message

Parent Groups

- Communicate with multiple parents
- Share class updates
- Coordinate events

Announcements

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/announcements`

Features

- Create and publish announcements
- Target specific classes or all students
- Set priority levels
- Schedule announcements
- Track announcement views

Creating an Announcement

1. Navigate to **Announcements**
2. Click **"Create New Announcement"**
3. Fill in details:
    - **Title**: Announcement headline
    - **Category**: Academic, General, Event, etc.
    - **Priority**: Low, Medium, High
    - **Target Audience**: All Students, Specific Classes, Parents
    - **Content**: Full announcement text
4. Select classes (if targeting specific classes)
5. Set publication date (optional)
6. Click **"Create Announcement"**

Announcement Categories

- **Academic**: Course updates, assignment reminders
- **General**: School-wide information
- **Event**: Upcoming events and activities
- **Urgent**: Important time-sensitive information

Managing Announcements

Viewing Announcements

- See all your announcements
- Filter by status (Draft, Published, Archived)
- Search by title or content
- View announcement statistics

Editing Announcements

1. Open an announcement
2. Click **"Edit"**
3. Modify content or settings
4. Save changes

Announcement Statistics

- View count: How many students viewed
- Engagement: Response rates
- Reach: Number of recipients

Parent Communication

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/parents`

Features

- View parent directory
- Contact parents via email or message
- Access student-parent relationships
- Track communication history

Accessing Parent Directory

1. Navigate to **Parents**
2. View parent list
3. Search by parent name, student name, or email
4. Filter by relationship type

Contacting Parents

Email

1. Find parent in directory
2. Click **"Email"** icon
3. Compose email (opens default email client)
4. Send email

Messaging

1. Find parent in directory
2. Click **"Message"** icon
3. Start conversation in messaging system
4. Send message

Parent Information

Available Details

- Parent name and contact information
- Relationship to student(s)
- Associated students
- Communication preferences

Student-Parent Relationships

- View which parents are associated with which students
- Access student information through parent record
- Track family communication history

Planning & Scheduling

Calendar

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/calendar`

Features

- View all events and deadlines
- Create custom events
- Filter by event type
- Monthly, weekly, and daily views
- Integration with assignments and assessments

Calendar Views

Month View

- See entire month at a glance
- Color-coded event types
- Quick navigation between months

Week View

- Detailed weekly schedule
- Time-based event display
- Daily breakdown

Day View

- Hourly schedule
- Detailed event information
- Time management

Event Types

- **Assignments**: Due dates and deadlines
- **Assessments**: Test and quiz dates
- **Academic Events**: School-wide events

- **Custom Events**: Personal reminders

Creating Events

1. Navigate to **Calendar**
2. Click on a date or **"Create Event"**
3. Fill in event details:
    - **Title**: Event name
    - **Type**: Assignment, Assessment, Academic Event
    - **Date and Time**: Start and end times
    - **Description**: Additional details
    - **Class**: Associated class (optional)
4. Save event

Managing Events

Viewing Events

- Click on any event to see details
- Filter by type (Assignments, Assessments, Events)
- Search events

Editing Events

1. Click on an event
2. Click **"Edit"**
3. Modify details
4. Save changes

Deleting Events

1. Click on an event
2. Click **"Delete"**
3. Confirm deletion

Schedule

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/schedule`

Features

- View teaching schedule
- See class timings and locations

- Track work hours
- View room assignments
- Export schedule

Viewing Schedule

1. Navigate to **Schedule**
2. View your weekly schedule
3. See class timings and room numbers
4. Check work hours and breaks

Schedule Information

Class Schedule

- Day of week
- Start and end times
- Room number
- Class name

Work Schedule

- Total work days
- Work hours per week
- Break times
- Availability

Room Schedule

- Room assignments
- Room capacity
- Room type
- Availability

Schedule Statistics

- Total classes per week
- Work days count
- Total work hours
- Average hours per day

Student Assignments

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/student-assignments`

Features

- Create assignments for individual students
- Track personalized assignments
- Monitor student-specific work
- Manage differentiated instruction

Creating Student Assignments

1. Navigate to **Student Assignments**
2. Click **"New Assignment"**
3. Fill in details:
    - **Title**: Assignment name
    - **Student**: Select target student(s)
    - **Class**: Associated class
    - **Description**: Instructions
    - **Due Date**: Deadline
    - **Max Points**: Total points
4. Save assignment

Managing Student Assignments

Viewing Assignments

- Filter by student
- Filter by class
- Search by title
- View assignment status

Tracking Progress

- See which students have completed assignments
- Track submission status
- Monitor individual progress

Analytics & Reports

Analytics Dashboard

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/analytics`

Features

- View performance metrics
- Track student engagement
- Analyze grade distributions
- Monitor attendance trends
- Generate insights

Analytics Overview

Key Metrics

- Total courses and active courses
- Total students
- Average grade
- Average attendance
- Student engagement score

Grade Distribution

- Visual breakdown of grades (A, B, C, D, F)
- Percentage distribution
- Trend analysis

Attendance Trends

- Attendance percentage over time
- Pattern identification
- Comparison with previous periods

Analytics Tabs

Overview

- Summary statistics
- Key performance indicators
- Quick insights

Performance

- Detailed grade analysis
- Student performance trends
- Class comparisons

Engagement

- Student participation metrics
- Assignment completion rates
- Activity levels

Attendance

- Attendance statistics
- Trend analysis
- Pattern identification

Time Period Selection

- Current Semester
- Current Year
- Last Semester
- Last Year
- Custom Range

Assessment Dashboard

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/assessments/dashboard`

Features

- View assessment analytics
- Track student performance
- Analyze question difficulty
- Generate assessment reports

Assessment Metrics

Performance Statistics

- Average score
- Highest and lowest scores

- Pass rate
- Completion rate

Question Analysis

- Question difficulty levels
- Most missed questions
- Time spent per question
- Answer distribution

Student Performance

- Individual student results
- Class performance comparison
- Improvement tracking

Activities

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/activities`

Features

- View recent activity log
- Track system actions
- Monitor changes
- Review activity history

Activity Types

- Assignment creation and updates
- Grade entries
- Attendance records
- Assessment activities
- Communication activities

Viewing Activities

1. Navigate to **Activities**
2. View activity timeline
3. Filter by activity type
4. Search activities
5. Export activity log

Personal Management

Profile

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/profile`

Features

- Update personal information
- Change profile picture
- Manage contact details
- Set preferences
- View account information

Updating Profile

1. Navigate to **Profile**
2. Click **"Edit Profile"**
3. Update information:
    - Name
    - Email
    - Phone number
    - Address
    - Profile picture
4. Save changes

Profile Information

Personal Details

- First name and last name
- Email address
- Phone number
- Date of birth
- Gender

Professional Information

- Staff code
- Department
- Position
- Hire date
- Qualifications

Account Settings

- Password management
- Notification preferences
- Privacy settings

Settings

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/settings`

Features

- Configure account settings
- Manage notifications
- Set preferences
- Security settings
- Privacy controls

Account Settings

General Settings

- Language preference
- Time zone
- Date format
- Theme (Light/Dark mode)

Notification Settings

- Email notifications
- In-app notifications
- Notification frequency
- Notification types

Security Settings

- Password change
- Two-factor authentication
- Session management
- Login history

Leave Management

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/leave`

Features

- Request leave
- View leave balance
- Track leave history
- Check leave status

Requesting Leave

1. Navigate to **Leave**
2. Click **"New Leave Request"**
3. Fill in details:
    - **Leave Type**: Sick, Personal, Vacation, etc.
    - **Start Date**: Leave start date
    - **End Date**: Leave end date
    - **Reason**: Leave reason
    - **Comments**: Additional information
4. Submit request

Managing Leave

Viewing Leave Balance

- Available leave days
- Used leave days
- Pending requests
- Leave history

Leave Status

- **Pending**: Awaiting approval
- **Approved**: Leave granted
- **Rejected**: Leave denied
- **Cancelled**: Request cancelled

Leave History

- Past leave requests
- Approved leaves
- Rejected requests

- Leave statistics

Payslips

Location: `/dashboard/teacher/payslips`

Features

- View payslip history
- Download payslips
- View salary details
- Track deductions
- Access tax information

Viewing Payslips

1. Navigate to **Payslips**
2. View payslip list
3. Filter by month or year
4. Click on a payslip to view details

Payslip Information

Salary Details

- Gross salary
- Net salary
- Basic pay
- Allowances
- Deductions

Tax Information

- Tax deductions
- Tax year
- Tax statements

Download Payslips

- Download as PDF
- Print payslips
- Email payslips

Quick Actions

From Dashboard

Take Attendance

- Quick access to attendance recording
- Select class and date
- Mark attendance quickly

Create Assignment

- Fast assignment creation
- Pre-filled with common settings
- Quick publish option

Grade Submissions

- Access pending grades
- Quick grading interface
- Bulk grading options

Create Assessment

- Quick assessment creation
- AI-enhanced option available
- Template selection

Student Messages

- Quick messaging interface
- Recent conversations
- New message creation

View Analytics

- Quick analytics overview
- Key metrics display
- Performance insights

Keyboard Shortcuts

- **Ctrl/Cmd + N**: New assignment
- **Ctrl/Cmd + A**: Take attendance
- **Ctrl/Cmd + G**: Grades
- **Ctrl/Cmd + M**: Messages
- **Ctrl/Cmd + K**: Search

Best Practices

Assignment Management

1. **Create assignments early**: Give students ample time
2. **Set clear due dates**: Avoid confusion
3. **Provide detailed instructions**: Reduce questions
4. **Use rubrics**: Consistent grading
5. **Grade promptly**: Timely feedback improves learning

Attendance

1. **Take attendance daily**: Maintain accurate records
2. **Mark attendance immediately**: Don't delay
3. **Use consistent statuses**: Standardize marking
4. **Add notes for exceptions**: Document special cases
5. **Review patterns**: Identify attendance issues early

Communication

1. **Respond promptly**: Answer messages within 24 hours
2. **Be clear and concise**: Avoid misunderstandings
3. **Use announcements for important info**: Reach all students
4. **Maintain professional tone**: Appropriate communication
5. **Document important conversations**: Keep records

Grading

1. **Grade consistently**: Use rubrics and standards
2. **Provide constructive feedback**: Help students improve
3. **Grade in batches**: Efficient workflow
4. **Enter grades promptly**: Keep records up-to-date
5. **Review grade distributions**: Identify issues

Assessment Creation

1. **Align with learning objectives**: Ensure relevance
2. **Use variety of question types**: Comprehensive assessment
3. **Test clarity**: Ensure questions are clear
4. **Review AI-generated questions**: Verify accuracy
5. **Set appropriate time limits**: Realistic expectations

Materials Management

1. **Organize by topic**: Easy to find
2. **Use descriptive titles**: Clear identification
3. **Update regularly**: Keep materials current
4. **Share relevant resources**: Enhance learning
5. **Check links periodically**: Ensure accessibility

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Cannot Access Dashboard

- Verify login credentials
- Check school code in URL
- Clear browser cache
- Contact IT support

Assignments Not Showing

- Check assignment status (must be Published)
- Verify class assignment
- Check date availability
- Refresh page

Grades Not Saving

- Check internet connection
- Verify all required fields are filled
- Try saving again
- Contact support if issue persists

Attendance Not Recording

- Verify class selection
- Check date is correct
- Ensure students are enrolled
- Try refreshing page

Messages Not Sending

- Check recipient selection
- Verify message content
- Check internet connection
- Try again

Materials Not Uploading

- Check file size limits
- Verify file format is supported
- Check internet connection
- Try smaller file

Getting Help

Support Resources

- Check this user manual
- Review FAQ section
- Contact school IT support
- Submit support ticket

Reporting Issues

1. Note the exact error message
2. Record steps to reproduce
3. Note browser and device information
4. Contact support with details

Appendix

Feature Summary

Feature	Location	Key Functions
Dashboard	`/dashboard/teacher`	Overview, quick actions, statistics
Classes	`/dashboard/teacher/classes`	Class management, rosters, attendance
Courses	`/dashboard/teacher/courses`	Course details, materials, enrollment
Assignments	`/dashboard/teacher/assignments`	Create, manage, grade assignments
Assessments	`/dashboard/teacher/assessments`	Create assessments, AI-enhanced options
Grades	`/dashboard/teacher/grades`	Grade entry, calculations, reports
Attendance	`/dashboard/teacher/attendance`	Record attendance, generate reports
Lessons	`/dashboard/teacher/lessons`	Create lesson plans, organize lessons
Materials	`/dashboard/teacher/materials`	Upload, organize course materials
Messaging	`/dashboard/teacher/messaging`	Communicate with students, parents, staff
Announcements	`/dashboard/teacher/announcements`	Create and publish announcements
Parents	`/dashboard/teacher/parents`	Parent directory, communication
Calendar	`/dashboard/teacher/calendar`	View events, create custom events

Feature	Location	Key Functions
Schedule	`/dashboard/teacher/schedule`	Teaching schedule, work hours
Student Assignments	`/dashboard/teacher/student-assignments`	Individual student assignments
Analytics	`/dashboard/teacher/analytics`	Performance metrics, insights
Activities	`/dashboard/teacher/activities`	Activity log, system actions
Profile	`/dashboard/teacher/profile`	Personal information, account settings
Settings	`/dashboard/teacher/settings`	Preferences, notifications, security
Leave	`/dashboard/teacher/leave`	Leave requests, balance, history
Payslips	`/dashboard/teacher/payslips`	View and download payslips

Keyboard Shortcuts Reference

- **Ctrl/Cmd + N**: New item (context-dependent)
- **Ctrl/Cmd + A**: Take attendance
- **Ctrl/Cmd + G**: Grades
- **Ctrl/Cmd + M**: Messages
- **Ctrl/Cmd + K**: Search
- **Ctrl/Cmd + S**: Save
- **Ctrl/Cmd + P**: Print
- **Esc**: Close dialog/modal

Glossary

- **Assignment**: Task given to students with due date and grading
- **Assessment**: Evaluation tool (test, quiz, exam) to measure learning
- **AI-Enhanced Assessment**: Assessment created with AI assistance
- **Class**: Group of students meeting together
- **Course**: Subject or curriculum being taught
- **Grade Item**: Individual graded component (assignment, quiz, etc.)

- **Lesson Plan**: Structured plan for teaching a lesson
- **Material**: Resource shared with students (document, video, link)
- **Multi-tenant**: System supporting multiple schools with data isolation
- **Staff Code**: Unique identifier for staff members
- **Student Code**: Unique identifier for students

Document Information

Version: 1.0
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Platform: SlateSMS
Audience: Teachers

For the latest updates and additional resources, please visit the SlateSMS documentation portal or contact your school administrator.

This user manual is designed to help teachers effectively use the SlateSMS Teacher Dashboard. For technical support or feature requests, please contact your school's IT department or SlateSMS support team.